

Malachi 3:6a
For I am the LORD, **I change not**;

The King James version of the Bible uses for its translation what is referred to as “Early Modern English” (circa late 15th century to mid-to-late 17th century). While the definitions and common usages of those words have remained the same since that time the English language has changed significantly since then such that it is now comparatively referred to as “Modern English.”

Because of that, when you read God’s word, it’s very likely that when you see a word the idea of what you think it means in your mind can very easily not be what God meant at all. If you think that Satan and his ministers aren’t both encouraging and using the difference in our understanding of the English language to deceive **many**, think again:

Isaiah 14:14b I will be like the most High.
2 Corinthians 11:14-15 14 And no marvel; for Satan himself is transformed into an angel of light. 15 Therefore it is no great thing if his ministers also be transformed as the ministers of righteousness; whose end shall be according to their works.

We’ll start with some simple examples and we’ll use the first two Google results for “English dictionary” to get our definitions from the world (Merriam-Webster and Cambridge, because Oxford requires a subscription!). You’ll quickly notice that the worlds definitions for words are useful for interacting with the world but they do the exact opposite when you try to use them to understand God’s word (**1 John 2:16**).

Studying God’s word takes *work* and it always will: **2 Timothy 2:15**: “...a **work**man”. If you try take the wrong shortcuts to make it easier, that is sin, and that man of sin is lying in wait to offer his candy coated poison (**Gen 4:7**: “...if thou doest not well, sin lieth at the door.”).

Conversation

The English word “conversation” appears 20 times in the King James Bible, in 20 different verses, in 16 different chapters, and in 10 different books. First, let’s look at the worlds definitions for this word.

Merriam-Websters Conversation (noun) 1 a (1): oral exchange of sentiments, observations, opinions, or ideas (2): an instance of such exchange: TALK b : an informal discussion of an issue by representatives of governments, institutions, or groups c : an exchange similar to conversation 2 obsolete : Conduct, Behavior
Cambridge Conversation (noun) a : talk between two or more people in which thoughts, feelings, and ideas are expressed, questions are asked and answered, or news and information is exchanged: b : an informal, usually private, talk in which two or more people exchange thoughts, feelings, or ideas, or in which news or information is given or discussed: c : a discussion with someone about a particular subject

Ignoring the definition that uses the word itself and the obsolete definition, which means it’s no longer used, let’s take those and apply those to God’s word.

1 Timothy 4:12 Let no man despise thy youth; but be thou an example of the believers, in word, in conversation, in charity, in spirit, in faith, in purity.

We could almost make that definition work here. However, it would appear that Paul may be a little senile in his old age because he’s just repeating himself if “in word” is exactly the same as “in conversation”. Note that the Bible does sometimes use two different words/phrases to describe the same thing and usually (but not always) that’s a new definition that God is teaching us (**Gen 1:2** “the deep” = “the waters”, **Gen 1:5** “light” = “Day” & “darkness” = “Night”, **Gen 6:8,9** “found grace” = “a just man”). That is not the case in this example.

Hebrews 13:7 Remember them which have the rule over you, who have spoken unto you the word of God: whose faith follow, considering the end of their conversation.

Speaking of spiritual leaders that God has placed over us, God commands: follow (or copy) their faith, considering the end of their ... speech? We can’t make that wordly definition make sense no matter how hard we try.

The very first time any Hebrew or Greek word (there are 5) appears in the Bible that was translated to “conversation” is:

Genesis 3:24 So he drove out the man; and he placed at the east of the garden of Eden Cherubims, and a flaming sword which turned every way, to keep the way ^{H1870} of the tree of life.
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Now think about that carefully but on a basic level. What exactly is “the way” to the tree of life in this context? It is a path or a road. If we were going on a long journey that we were unfamiliar with we would first obtain directions on how to get there: that is to say, we would want to know *the way*. Therefore, all those things that we would want to know can be summed up as: the way.

With that in mind, let’s look at the second time that the Hebrew word (H1870) that was translated to “conversation” appears in the Bible that is not “the way”:

Genesis 19:31 And the firstborn said unto the younger, Our father is old, and there is not a man in the earth to come in unto us after the manner ^{H1870} of all the earth:
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- “the manner”

And the third that is neither of the first two:

Genesis 24:21

And the man wondering at her held his peace, to wit whether the LORD had made his journey^{H1870} prosperous or not.

- “journey”

A fuller picture should already be forming in your mind. Not only does “conversation” encompass “the way” or “the manner”, but it also includes “the journey” which is not only the series of actions to traverse a path but also everything that happens along the way.

Genesis 31:35

And she said to her father, Let it not displease my lord that I cannot rise up before thee; for the custom^{H1870} of women is upon me. And he searched, but found not the images.

- “the custom”

Numbers 22:32

And the angel of the LORD said unto him, Wherefore hast thou smitten thine ass these three times? behold, I went out to withstand thee, because thy way^{H1870} is perverse before me:

Was the angel of the LORD displeased at the path through the vineyards that Balaam chose? No, of course not. He was displeased with Balaam because of his *actions*.

1 Kings 8:44

If thy people go out to battle against their enemy, whithersoever^{H1870} thou shalt send them, and shall pray unto the LORD toward^{H1870} the city which thou hast chosen, and toward the house that I have built for thy name:

- Whithersoever (to whatever place)
- Toward (a direction)

And then we come to the first time that “conversation” appears from H1870:

Psalms 37:14

The wicked have drawn out the sword, and have bent their bow, to cast down the poor and needy, and to slay such as be of upright conversation^{H1870}.

If you take all the ideas that we’ve gathered from God’s word and put them together God’s definition of “conversation” emerges. And then when you take His definition you will gain understanding (Pro 3:13):

Psalms 50:23

Whoso offereth praise glorifieth me: and to him that ordereth his conversation aright will I shew the salvation of God.

Ephesians 4:22-25

²² That ye put off concerning the former conversation the old man, which is corrupt according to the deceitful lusts;

Be sure to also go back and review 1 Timothy 4:12, and Hebrews 13:7.

Noah Websters 1828 dictionary

CONVERSATION, n.

- General course of manners; behavior; deportment; especially as it respects morals.
Let your conversation be as becometh the gospel. Phil 1.
Be ye holy in all manner of conversation. 1 Pet 1.
- A keeping company; familiar intercourse; intimate fellowship or association; commerce in social life.
Knowledge of men and manners is best acquired by conversation with the best company.
- Intimate and familiar acquaintance; as a conversation with books, or other object.
- Familiar discourse; general intercourse of sentiments; chat; unrestrained talk; opposed to a formal conference.
What I mentioned in conversation was not a new thought.
[This is now the most general use of the word.]

- Notice the scripture references in the first definition?
- Can we find any scripture references in any “modern” dictionary? Could it be because they have forsaken God? Proverbs 28:4.

Communicate

Merriam-Webster communicate (verb) 1 (a): to convey knowledge of or information about: make known (b): to reveal by clear signs 2: to cause to pass from one to another 3: archaic: share communicate (intransitive-verb) 1: to transmit information, thought, or feeling so that it is satisfactorily received or understood 2: to open into each other: connect 3: to receive Communion
Cambridge communicate (verb) 1. to share information with others by speaking, writing, moving your body, or using other signals. 2. to talk about your thoughts and feelings, and help other people to understand them 3. to pass a disease from one person or animal to another 4. If one room communicates with another, it connects with it through a door 5: to give messages or information to others through speech, writing, body movements, or signals 6. If two people communicate with each other, they are able to understand each other and have a satisfactory relationship

Galatians 2:2 And I went up by revelation, and communicated unto them that gospel which I preach among the Gentiles, but privately to them which were of reputation, lest by any means I should run, or had run, in vain.
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- What was communicated? That gospel.
- Who was it communicated to? The Gentiles (all peoples that are not Jewish).
- How was it communicated? He preached (spoke).

So far, so good, right? Now, try these:

Philippians 4:14 Notwithstanding ye have well done, that ye did communicate with my affliction.
Philippians 4:15 Now ye Philippians know also, that in the beginning of the gospel, when I departed from Macedonia, no church communicated with me as concerning giving and receiving, but ye only.

If we try to use any of the definitions we were given then Paul is saying that the Philippians *spoke* with/to his afflictions. Afflictions don’t have ears to hear. In the second verse, what does speaking to one another have to do with giving and receiving? Do you think the Philippians are being commended for only *speaking* towards giving to Paul’s needs? What profit would that be? Absolutely none: James 2:15,16, 1 John 3:17. Moreover, acknowledging someone’s need and then not providing it (when you can) shows that one does not have the love of God in them. None of the definitions we were given make any sense and worse yet they leave us confused – of which God is not the author (1Cor 14:33). So, who is the author of lies and the confusion that results from them? The father of lies himself:

John 8:44 Ye are of your father the devil, and the lusts of your father ye will do. He was a murderer from the beginning, and abode not in the truth, because there is no truth in him. When he speaketh a lie, he speaketh of his own: for he is a liar, and the father of it.
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Communicate does not appear in the old testament and so there are only Greek Strong’s numbers for it: G2841, G2842, and G2843. Here is a summary of them:

Acts 2:42	Fellowship
Romans 12:13	Distributing
Romans 15:26,27, 1 Timothy 5:22, 1 Peter 4:13	Contribution, partaker(s)
1 Corinthians 10:16 (2x), 2 Corinthians 6:14	Communion

Do any of those words in the right column make more sense when used as a definition for communicate in Philippians 4:14,15? Of course they do, because we’re using God’s word to define God’s word!

Noah Webster’s 1828 dictionary

COMMUNICATE, verb transitive

- 1. To impart; to give to another, as a partaker; to confer for joint possession; to bestow, as that which the receiver is to hold, retain, use or enjoy; with to.
Where God is worshiped, there he communicates his blessings and holy influences.
Let him that is taught in the word communicate to him that teacheth in all good things. Gal 6.
- 2. To impart reciprocally, or mutually; to have or enjoy a share of; followed by with.
Common benefits are to be communicated with all, but peculiar benefits with choice.
But Diamede desires my company, and still communicates his praise with me.
- 3. To impart, as knowledge; to reveal; to give, as information, either by words, signs or signals; as, to communicate intelligence, news, opinions, or facts.
Formerly this verb had *with* before the person receiving; as, he communicated those thoughts only *with* the Lord Digby. Clarendon. But now it has to only.
- 4. To deliver, as to communicate a message; to give, as to communicate motion.

COMMUNICATE, verb intransitive

- 1. To partake of the Lords supper. Instead of this, in America, at least in New England, commune is generally or always used.
- 2. To have a communication or passage from one to another; to have the means of passing from one to another; as, two houses communicate with each other; a fortress communicates with the country; the canals of the body communicate with each other.
- 3. To have intercourse; applied to persons.
- 4. To have, enjoy or suffer reciprocally; to have a share with another.
Ye have done well that ye did communicate with my affliction. Phil 4.

Doctor(s)

The word “doctor(s)” appears 3 times in the Bible.

Luke 2:46 And it came to pass, that after three days they found him in the temple, sitting in the midst of the doctors, both hearing them, and asking them questions.
Luke 5:17 And it came to pass on a certain day, as he was teaching, that there were Pharisees and doctors of the law sitting by, which were come out of every town of Galilee, and Judaea, and Jerusalem: and the power of the Lord was present to heal them.
Acts 5:34 Then stood there up one in the council, a Pharisee, named Gamaliel, a doctor of the law, had in reputation among all the people, and commanded to put the apostles forth a little space;

The examples are all nouns so we'll focus on nouns in the definitions as well.

Merriam-Webster doctor (noun) 1 a: Christianity : an eminent theologian declared a sound expounder of doctrine by the Roman Catholic Church b: a learned or authoritative teacher c: a person who has earned one of the highest academic degrees (such as a PhD) conferred by a university d: a person awarded an honorary doctorate (such as an LLD or Litt D) by a college or university 2 a: a person skilled or specializing in healing arts b: medicine man 3 a: material added (as to food) to produce a desired effect b: a blade (as of metal) for spreading a coating or scraping a surface 4: a person who restores, repairs, or fine-tunes things
Cambridge doctor (noun) 1. a person with a medical degree whose job is to treat people who are sick or hurt: 2. a person who has the highest degree (= qualification) from a college or university

According to Merriam-Webster, you can't be a doctor in Christianity unless the Roman Catholic church says so. And that's the only theologically based definition we are given. If we use any of the other definitions we would quickly arrive at error.

And yet in God's word we see doctors in the synagogue when Jesus was a young lad. We see them with the Pharisees that came out of Galilee and we also see at least one on the council (the Jewish high court, also known as the Sanhedrin).

And all of that roughly 350 years before the Roman Catholic church even existed.

The definition of doctor as used in God's word, and defined by God's word is (G1320): master(s), teacher(s). And by extension “Rabbi” (**Mat 23:8**).

Let's see what Noah Websters 1828 dictionary has to say.

Noah Websters 1828 DOCTOR, n. [L., to teach.] 1. A teacher. There stood up one in the council, a Pharisee, named Gamaliel, a doctor of the law. Acts 5. 2. One who has passed all the degrees of a faculty, and is empowered to practice and teach it, as a doctor in divinity, in physic, in law; or according to modern usage, a person who has received the highest degree in a faculty. The degree of doctor is conferred by universities and colleges, as an honorary mark of literary distinction. It is also conferred on physicians, as a professional degree. 3. A learned man; a man skilled in a profession; a man of erudition. 4. A physician; one whose occupation is to cure diseases. 5. The title, doctor, is given to certain fathers of the church whose opinions are received as authorities, and in the Greek church, it is given to a particular officer who interprets the scriptures. Doctors Commons, the college of civilians in London.

Wow. We have to be very careful with this one. Can you spot the sin in this definition? Here’s some guidance from *the* Master Jesus:

Matthew 23:8,9
8 But be not ye called Rabbi: for one is your Master, even Christ; and all ye are brethren.
9 And call no man your father upon the earth: for one is your Father, which is in heaven.

- Rabbi means master (John 1:38).
- Calling spiritual leaders “father” or “master” is sin.
 - Specifically, it’s idolatry: when we put anything above God: Exodus 20:3-6

Job 32:21-22
21 Let me not, I pray you, accept any man’s person, neither let me give flattering titles unto man.
22 For I know not to give flattering titles; in so doing my maker would soon take me away.

- Elihu knew the consequences of idolatry and avoided it as we should too: Romans 6:23.

So, hopefully with all that you’ve learned a little more about why it’s so important to not use the world’s definitions for words but instead use the Bible to define itself.

How exactly you go about doing that is a matter between you and God (John 16:13, 1 John 5:7). But, also make sure (1Thess 5:21) that the word definitions that you are using are coming from the most reliable source: God.

I’ll leave you with one final example that we all know well. It’s a great example of how twisted the world is.

James 2:3
And ye have respect to him that weareth the gay clothing, and say unto him, Sit thou here in a good place; and say to the poor, Stand thou there, or sit here under my footstool:

The worlds definition: sodomy or the association with it (Leviticus 20:13). James 1:27 “...keep himself unspotted from the world.”

God’s definition (G2986): gorgeous, bright, goodly, white, clear.

Little children, keep yourselves from idols.